

CORESKILLS

Freelancing Client Acquisition Toolkit

Free sample edition: practical outreach, discovery and proposal structures for new freelancers.

Educational material. No client, income or employment outcome is guaranteed.

Choose a clear service before outreach

Potential clients respond more easily when they can understand what you do, who it is for and what business problem it addresses. Replace a broad label such as “I do digital marketing” with a clear service statement.

Service statement template

I help [specific type of customer] improve [specific business outcome] by providing [defined service or deliverable].

Qualification checklist

- The prospect appears to use or need the type of service you provide.
- You can identify a relevant observation without inventing a problem.
- The organisation has a legitimate public presence and contact route.
- Your message can explain why you selected this prospect specifically.
- You can deliver the work responsibly if the prospect accepts.

Responsible outreach: personalise messages, respect opt-outs, avoid scraping private data and do not send misleading mass claims.

A professional first message

The goal of the first message is not to force a sale. It is to establish relevance, show that you reviewed the prospect's situation and invite a low-pressure next step.

Outreach structure

Subject: A specific idea for [business/project]

Hello [name],

I noticed [truthful, relevant observation]. I work with [relevant audience] on [defined service]. One possible improvement could be [concise idea], because [reason connected to a business outcome].

If this is currently a priority, I can send a short outline of the approach and likely scope. If not, no problem.

Regards,
[name and portfolio/contact]

Before sending

- Verify the person's name and role.
- Remove exaggerated claims and guaranteed outcomes.
- Keep the message readable on a phone.
- Include one clear next step, not several competing requests.

Discovery call question bank

A discovery call should help both sides decide whether the project is a suitable fit. Ask only questions that help clarify the work.

Goals and context

- What prompted you to consider this project now?
- What should be different when the project is complete?
- Who will use, review or approve the deliverable?

Scope and constraints

- What already exists, and what needs to be created?
- Are there fixed technical, brand, legal or timeline constraints?
- What content, access or decisions will your team provide?

Decision and next steps

- Who makes the final decision?
- What timeline is realistic for reviewing a proposal?
- Is there a budget range approved for this work?

Do not promise a price or deadline until you understand dependencies, revision expectations and approval stages.

Proposal essentials

1. **Context:** a concise summary of the client's stated problem and goal.
2. **Scope:** precise deliverables and explicit exclusions.
3. **Process:** milestones, feedback stages and responsibilities.
4. **Timeline:** estimated dates dependent on timely inputs and approvals.
5. **Commercial terms:** price, taxes if applicable, payment milestones and validity period.
6. **Change control:** how work outside scope will be estimated and approved.
7. **Next step:** how the client can accept and begin onboarding.

Full toolkit contents

The complete product includes expanded outreach variations, follow-up sequences, a proposal framework, pricing worksheet, discovery notes and a project onboarding checklist.

Support and policies

Support: growora.org@gmail.com

Website: <https://coreskills.com>

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